Prahlin Portfolio Work Log - October 15, 2026

Compiled summary for Thursday, October 15, 2026 - focus: continuing the Prahl.dev Portfolio after the October 13 five-key philosophy, five-stage workflow, and interactive Core Beliefs record; independently verifying the United States Eastern date; refreshing the repository snapshot; extracting and studying the complete pre-existing PDF worklog archive; matching Core Beliefs headers to the shared Workflow gradients; rebuilding the Core Beliefs background-star opacity treatment with independent top, bottom, and horizontal masks; removing the visible mask seam; restarting condensation-line animation on every click; enlarging and moving the contrail paths away from the formation center; exploring a new five-part Productivity Hacks visual language through desktop and portrait mockups; implementing the selected circuit-bench concept between My Core Beliefs and Work Space; building distinct wide and narrow responsive compositions; adding content-safe placeholder cards, tool icons, circuit routing, and star motifs; correcting a stale local Next.js stylesheet cache; validating type safety, production compilation, routes, responsive geometry, content growth, and repository state; documenting commits ca1a562 and 988ad28; and generating the October 15 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahlin Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening synthesis, source-material review, prior baseline, goals, grouped work-completed sections, committed-source chronology, validation, files and artifacts, follow-up context, and an output-artifact close. This record emphasizes completed implementation and observable repository evidence while retaining only the design exploration necessary to explain the accepted result.

Coverage begins after portfolio_worklog_october13.pdf and documentation commit 2b0f267. The application work is represented by two October 15 commits on main, ending at 988ad28ce622fa2e47a7ceed15f39908dad90efa, which matches origin/main. No GitHub Actions dispatch, Hostinger synchronization, deploy-branch mutation, or production release was performed during this documentation pass. Before PDF creation, the only uncommitted delta was the reader-refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Date verification: TZ=America/New_York returned Thursday, October 15, 2026 at 8:44:12 PM EDT with the UTC-04:00 offset. A second check at 8:49:33 PM returned the same Eastern calendar date and offset. October 15 remains within United States Eastern Daylight Time, so both the title and filename use October 15 rather than the execution host's default or UTC date.
- Project reader: ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio. It refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt at 8:48:47 PM EDT to 20,068 lines and 668,655 bytes, preserving current source, assets, configuration, Git history, PDF inventory, and standing workflow instructions.
- Worklog archive: enumerated and extracted all 53 pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDF worklogs, spanning July 11 through October 13. The archive contains 303 pages and approximately 151,748 extracted words, including established same-day Part suffixes where earlier sessions required more than one record.
- Archive comparison: compared filename cadence, title construction, opening-summary density, recurring section order, engineering-bullet voice, validation language, file inventories, follow-up continuity, footer placement, pagination, and document metadata across the complete set. Used October 13 as the direct chronological baseline and October 9, October 8, October 7, and September 29 Part 2 as the nearest structural and visual references.
- PDF convention: confirmed US Letter portrait at 612 x 792 points, PDF 1.4, no encryption, black text on white, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold Type 1 fonts, a dated first-page title, repeated footer title, right-aligned page numbers, compact margins, and Codex author/creator/producer metadata.
- Git evidence: inspected the full commit bodies, file statistics, and final source for ca1a5621d62a01b432f0224dd4e209d45f331fe4 and 988ad28ce622fa2e47a7ceed15f39908dad90efa. Relative to the October 13 documentation commit, the tracked implementation range changed five files with 770 insertions and 45 deletions.
- Runtime evidence: reviewed the live landing page, the final Core Beliefs implementation, the new ProductivityHacks component, responsive CSS, desktop and mobile screenshots, computed card geometry, long-copy stress results, route responses, TypeScript output, and the successful production build recorded during implementation.

Baseline Status Before October 15

- My Core Beliefs already used five orbiting bubbles and the shared stylish five-color star, but belief titles still used earlier flat tone colors rather than the exact masked gradients and black outline language established by My Workflow and UI / UX Philosophy.
- The Core Beliefs star used one radial opacity mask. It did not independently control the upper vertical rise, upper horizontal falloff, and lower radial fade, so user-directed opacity tuning could not distinguish the top and bottom halves.
- Experimental split-mask work exposed a visible horizontal boundary through the star center. Repeated rotations also made it important that the mask remain fixed to the viewport rather than rotate with whichever colored point happened to face upward.
- Condensation paths animated during the carousel state transition but did not reliably restart on every repeated click. The accepted paths also remained too close to the bubbles and star formation, reducing the outward kinetic effect.
- The landing page had no Productivity Hacks section between My Core Beliefs and Work Space. Its existing major sections deliberately differed from one another, so reusing the Core Beliefs radial-bubble structure would have weakened the page's visual variety.
- No final productivity copy was available. The implementation therefore needed explicit placeholders and card sizing that could absorb later variation in heading and paragraph length without fixed-height clipping.

Goals for October 15

- Match all five Core Beliefs headers to the exact purple, yellow, blue, orange, and green Workflow typography gradients while retaining the established two-pixel black outline and readable fallback color.
- Build independent star-mask rules for the top and bottom vertical halves, preserve orientation independently of star rotation, remove the seam between masks, and honor the accepted final opacity stops.

- Restart condensation animation immediately on each eligible belief click, enlarge its path geometry by 50 percent, and reposition it outward from the fixed formation center without moving the bubbles themselves.
- Explore a distinct five-part Productivity Hacks metaphor that still belongs to the dark green grid system, uses the five established gradients, and includes one or more five-pointed star ideas without recreating the Core Beliefs orbit.
- Implement the selected circuit-bench direction as one semantic five-card section with a wide-screen folded route and a narrow-screen stacked route.
- Make card dimensions content-safe, provide brief placeholder headings and paragraphs for later replacement, preserve accessible section structure, prevent horizontal overflow, and validate the finished behavior at desktop and phone widths.

Work Completed - Core Beliefs Gradient Typography

- Added data-title to each visible belief title so the component can render a solid outlined fallback and a separate masked gradient overlay using the same authored label.
- Mapped the belief sequence to the exact shared five-family order: purple, yellow, blue, orange, and green. Each title now receives the same core, middle, and edge values used by the corresponding Workflow name and philosophy key family.
- Applied a two-pixel black text stroke beneath the colored overlay. The overlay uses background-clip text plus a soft radial alpha mask, preserving definition against the dark bubble surface without turning the title into a flat neon fill.
- Kept the title treatment data-driven through CSS custom properties. Future belief-label changes need only update the visible title string because data-title mirrors the same value in the component markup.
- Preserved the bubble-specific border, glow, shadow, and interior gradient treatments introduced on October 13. The change refined header hierarchy without replacing the accepted bubble geometry or five-color relationship.

Work Completed - Core Beliefs Star Masks and Seam Repair

- Replaced the single masked star image with two synchronized copies of the same stylish source asset. Both copies inherit the same carousel rotation, while their wrapper masks remain locked to the physical top and bottom halves of the section.
- Built the upper vertical mask from 100 percent opacity at the top edge to 25 percent at the vertical center. This lets the upper point remain visually present while still transitioning into the darker center relationship requested during iteration.
- Added an independent upper horizontal mask with final stops of 2 percent at the left edge, 36 percent at 33 percent, 100 percent at the horizontal center, 36 percent at 67 percent, and 2 percent at the right edge.
- Built the lower radial mask with the accepted sequence: 18 percent at the center, 18 percent at 10 percent, 12 percent at 20 percent, 6 percent at 30 percent, 3 percent at 40 percent, 2 percent at 50 percent, and 1 percent at the outer edge.
- Intersected the vertical, horizontal, and radial masks through standard and WebKit composite rules so each layer contributes to the final alpha instead of replacing the preceding rule.
- Eliminated the hard horizontal line between the two star copies by feathering the ownership boundary from 48 to 52 percent. The two identical rotating images now crossfade through the center instead of meeting at an abrupt one-pixel seam.
- Kept the star's color rotation independent from mask orientation. Whichever colored point rotates upward receives the same physical top treatment, satisfying the requirement that opacity follow vertical position rather than a named color.

Work Completed - Core Beliefs Condensation Motion

- Added a contrailPulseId state value that increments whenever the selected belief changes. The SVG now remounts with the new pulse key, restarting its CSS animation immediately on each click instead of waiting for the previous 900-millisecond carousel settlement.
- Preserved the existing animation-state timer and shortest-route orbit logic. The pulse restart is additive and does not alter which bubble becomes active or how the star rotates.
- Promoted the fixed formation center to a named constant at x 495 and y 435, then introduced a 1.5 scale factor for the generated path coordinates.
- Scaled every start point, quadratic control point, and end point away from that fixed center. The condensation geometry became 50 percent larger and visibly farther outward while retaining the original curved relationships and paired offset paths.
- Verified rapid repeated clicks by observing sequential pulse identifiers and active animation states. The motion cue now responds to user input rather than behaving as a one-time consequence of settled carousel state.

Work Completed - Productivity Hacks Design Direction

- Studied Featured Case Studies, UI / UX Philosophy, Built around React Native, My Workflow, and My Core Beliefs to identify the shared dark grid, green structural lines, glass surfaces, strong section spacing, rounded geometry, and five-color system without copying any one section's composition.
- Generated three initial text-free concepts centered on a radial star selector, an exploded five-panel star, and a star viewport with orbiting tabs. These were rejected as too close to the Core Beliefs organization.
- Produced three deliberately non-radial alternatives: a focus prism sending five beams into staggered panels, an origami route forming a star through negative space, and a five-channel productivity mixing desk whose fader points trace a star.
- Selected the origami-route direction, then explored tool-belt, folding-circuit-bench, and kinetic-workshop variants. The folding circuit bench became the preferred implementation basis because its flexible board, traces, diagnostic panels, and star cutout connected productivity, tools, hacking, and tinkering without repeating the bubble orbit.
- Tested a super-narrow portrait adaptation before implementation. The accepted mobile direction changed the five panels into aligned horizontal cards, removed the shared central star, and placed one faint single-family star inside each card.
- Kept all generated mockups outside the repository as ideation references. No raster mockup asset was added to the application; the final section is implemented through React, SVG, CSS gradients, Lucide icons, and responsive layout rules.

Work Completed - Responsive Productivity Hacks Section

- Added app/ProductivityHacks.tsx as a dedicated data-driven component and inserted it between My Core Beliefs and the Work Space / Work Tools section on the landing page.
- Created five placeholder entries with CPU, wrench, terminal, blocks, and gauge icons. Each entry carries a brief temporary heading, a brief temporary paragraph, and its own core, middle, and edge gradient variables for later copy replacement.
- Built the wide-screen composition as five responsive grid columns over a custom SVG circuit ribbon. Alternating card offsets create the accepted folded route, while purple, yellow, blue, orange, and green ribbon segments converge around a central five-pointed cutout and illuminated outline.
- Added copper-style traces, dark diagnostic preview wells, rivets, status pills, glass surfaces, thin gradient borders, restrained colored shadows, and color-matched heading treatments without introducing a new external image dependency.
- Used minimum heights rather than fixed heights. Card width follows the grid, text wraps by available space, and additional copy increases the card and section height rather than clipping inside an ornamental shell.
- At widths of 820 pixels and below, replaced the desktop SVG route with a centered vertical circuit spine and a single-column stack. All five cards share the same horizontal alignment and full available width, matching the compact portrait direction.
- Added one low-opacity five-point background star to every mobile card. Each star uses only its owning card's purple, yellow, blue, orange, or green gradient family; no mobile card contains the combined five-color star.
- Kept the mobile cards landscape-oriented through a three-column internal layout: tool icon, flexible text region, and compact diagnostic preview. The arrangement remains semantic and content-responsive rather than relying on a fixed raster mockup.
- Preserved explicit section framing with the Tools, Systems & Shortcuts eyebrow, the Productivity Hacks title, a brief placeholder introduction, and placeholder card copy that makes later content replacement visible and intentional.

Work Completed - Responsive Verification and Local Cache Recovery

- Rendered the completed section at 1600 by 1000 and 390 by 844 viewports. The desktop cards measured 224 pixels wide across five columns; the mobile cards measured 366 pixels wide, shared the same x position, and remained fully inside the 390-pixel viewport.
- Confirmed document scroll width exactly matched viewport width at both tested sizes. Neither the SVG ribbon, shifted desktop cards, vertical mobile spine, card shadows, nor preview wells introduced horizontal page overflow.
- Replaced an overly aggressive anywhere wrap on desktop headings with normal word boundaries, then retained break-word behavior on compact layouts. Placeholder titles now wrap between words rather than splitting final letters onto isolated lines.
- Added a visible gradient edge to the desktop star cutout so the dark negative-space star remains legible against the nearly black page background.
- Stress-tested content growth by replacing one placeholder paragraph in the rendered DOM with the phrase Long placeholder copy repeated 24 times. The target card expanded to approximately 979 pixels on desktop and 494 pixels on mobile; client height equaled scroll height in both cases, demonstrating that later long copy is not clipped.
- Detected a stale Turbopack stylesheet after the new markup appeared without its new CSS. Restarting the server alone did not invalidate the stale bundle, so the existing .next directory was moved into an ignored .next.cleared-productivity-* cache archive and the local server was restarted from a clean cache.
- Repeated the cache refresh after the final typography and star-outline polish. The rebuilt stylesheet exposed the expected grid rules and final computed 17-pixel desktop heading size.

Committed Source Sequence

- ca1a562 - Matched belief headers to the five Workflow text gradients with masked color treatments and black outlines. Rebuilt the star with independent masks and a seamless center crossfade, restarted contrail pulses on click, enlarged paths by 50 percent, moved them outward, and refreshed the project snapshot.
- 988ad28 - Added the responsive Productivity Hacks section. Inserted the new component between Core Beliefs and Work Space, built the five-card desktop circuit ribbon, created the aligned mobile card stack with per-card stars, added placeholder content and icons, and validated content-responsive sizing.
- At documentation time, HEAD, main, and origin/main all resolve to 988ad28ce622fa2e47a7ceed15f39908dad90efa. Both October 15 application commits are committed and synchronized; this worklog pass has not created a commit, push, deployment, or external release.

Validation Summary

- npm run check completed successfully against the current source.
- The production build completed successfully during the Productivity Hacks implementation. Next.js compiled, finished TypeScript, collected page data, generated all seven static routes, and finalized optimization without a build failure.
- The locally served routes /, /projects/alla-vostra, /projects/cinerific, /aboutdev, and /articles each returned HTTP 200 during the documentation pass.
- Source-scoped git diff --check passed for app/. The reader-generated snapshot contains preserved tabular trailing whitespace from its source dumps, so the snapshot was intentionally excluded from the source hygiene assertion rather than mechanically rewriting generated documentation.
- Desktop geometry at 1600 pixels showed five responsive cards, the shared circuit route, central star outline, card-specific colors, and no horizontal overflow. Card heights varied with placeholder length as intended.
- Mobile geometry at 390 pixels showed five equal-width horizontally aligned cards at x 12, a 366-pixel card width, the vertical circuit spine, distinct monochrome background stars, and no horizontal overflow.
- The long-copy stress test confirmed that card shells expand instead of clipping. The same semantic component supports both orientations; no duplicated mobile-only content source is required.

- Core Beliefs source review confirmed two masked star halves, the 48-to-52-percent center feather, the final top horizontal and lower radial stops, data-title gradient overlays, click pulse identifiers, and the 1.5 contrail scale around the fixed formation center.
- Repository status before PDF creation showed only portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt modified by the customary project-reader refresh.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/CoreBeliefsOrbit.tsx - fixed formation-center constants, scaled contrail geometry, click-driven SVG pulse remounting, gradient-title data attributes, and separate synchronized top/bottom star images.
- app/ProductivityHacks.tsx - new five-card data model, tool icons, placeholder copy, circuit-ribbon SVG, central star mask/outline, accessible section structure, and card markup.
- app/globals.css - Core Beliefs title gradients, split star masks, seam feather, and the complete desktop/mobile Productivity Hacks visual and responsive system.
- app/page.tsx - imported and placed ProductivityHacks between My Core Beliefs and Work Space.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - refreshed project reader output produced during the October 15 implementation and again during this documentation pass.
- portfolio_worklog_october15.pdf - new customary root-level worklog generated by this pass.

Follow-Up Notes

- Replace Productivity Hacks placeholder headings and paragraphs when final editorial content is available. The component is intentionally data-driven; update the productivityHacks array rather than duplicating card markup.
- Preserve the desktop/mobile conceptual distinction. Desktop uses one shared folded circuit route and central star cutout; mobile uses a vertical spine and one low-opacity single-color star per card.
- Keep the five color families in their established order unless a later content mapping explicitly requires a different semantic relationship: purple, yellow, blue, orange, and green.
- Do not add fixed card heights when final copy arrives. The current minimum-height and auto-growth behavior was tested specifically to accommodate uneven heading and paragraph lengths.
- Preserve the split Core Beliefs star wrappers if mask values change. Combining the rules back onto one rotating image would couple opacity to color orientation and reintroduce the limitation corrected in this pass.
- Maintain the 48-to-52-percent feather when tuning either star half. A hard 50-percent boundary produced the visible center line rejected during iteration.
- Keep contrail pulse remounting tied to actual selection changes. The pulse identifier is what allows repeated clicks to restart the condensation cue without waiting for the orbit transition to finish.
- If new CSS appears absent in local development, clear or move the .next cache before judging the implementation. The stale stylesheet observed during this pass survived a normal server restart.
- Before committing or pushing this documentation pass, review the refreshed snapshot and PDF together and use a past-tense commit message that distinguishes documentation generation from the two already-synchronized application commits.

Output Artifact

- Generated /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_october15.pdf using the established lowercase-month, non-zero-padded-day filename for the first worklog on October 15.
- The artifact uses US Letter portrait pages, PDF 1.4, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold, compact black-on-white technical prose, repeated dated footers, right-aligned page numbers, and Codex metadata consistent with the mature archive.
- The recorded application baseline is 988ad28ce622fa2e47a7ceed15f39908dad90efa on synchronized main and origin/main. No application source was edited while creating this record.
- Documentation deltas created by this pass are the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt and portfolio_worklog_october15.pdf. No deployment, remote message, branch mutation, or production publish was performed.